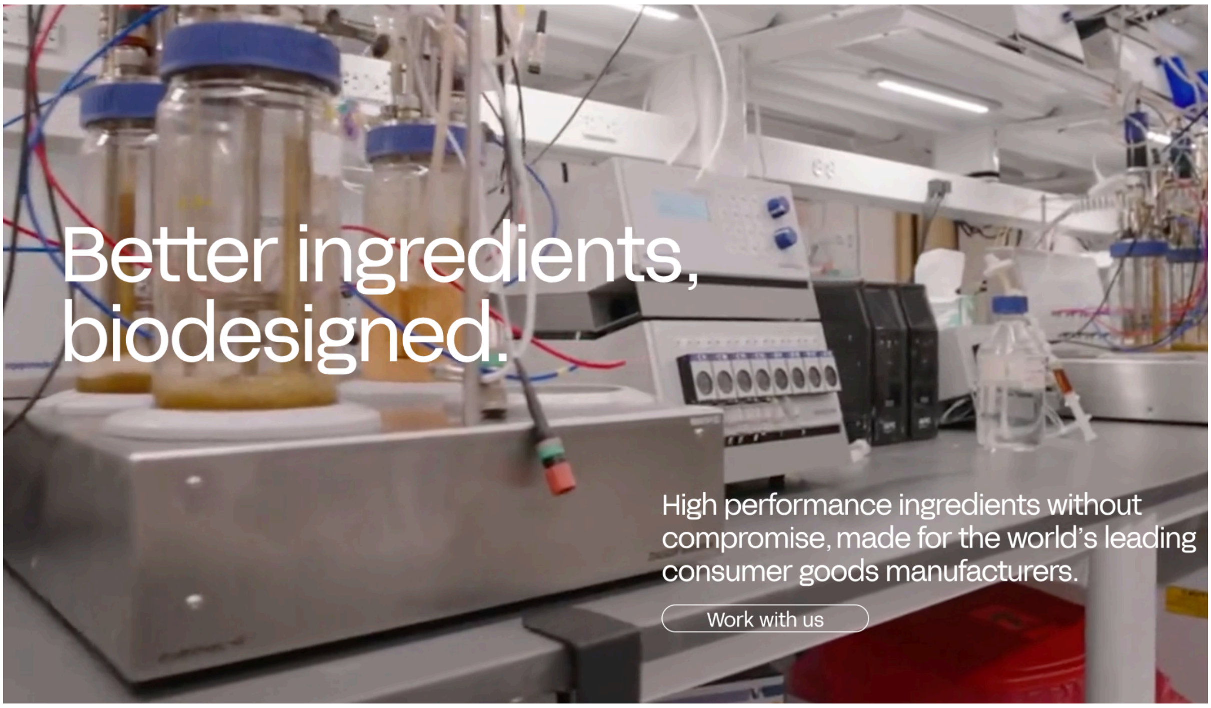
C16 Biosciences

Company Overview C16 Biosciences is a New York-based biotechnology company. They are not a traditional "farm" or "factory"; instead, they use microbiology to create sustainable alternatives to palm oil, which is found in about 50% of all consumer products, from lipstick to soap.

ESG Focus: Palmless™ (Lab-Grown Bio-Oils)



Better ingredients, biodesigned.

High performance ingredients without compromise, made for the world's leading consumer goods manufacturers.

Why (The Problem) Palm oil is the most popular vegetable oil in the world because it is cheap and versatile. However, its production is the leading cause of deforestation in tropical rainforests. This destroys the homes of endangered animals like orangutans and releases massive amounts of carbon stored in the trees and soil.

How (The Solution) C16 Biosciences developed a technology called "Precision Fermentation." They use a specific type of yeast and feed it with a carbon source (like sugar or industrial waste). As the yeast grows in large steel tanks, it naturally produces an oil that is chemically almost identical to palm oil.

What (The Outcome) This results in "Palmless™" oil. It provides the same smooth texture and moisturizing benefits as palm oil but is grown in a lab in New York instead of a rainforest in Indonesia. It requires significantly less land and water and doesn't involve any deforestation.

Impact: The company is currently scaling up production to supply major beauty and food brands. By 2026, they aim to replace a significant percentage of the world's palm oil demand, helping to protect tropical biodiversity while keeping supply chains stable.